

Cleared For Taxi

Clear instructions in plain English, useful answers every time

— THE FOUR FLIGHT CONTROLS

Context. What's the situation, and who's involved? *"I'm writing to my strata manager about a leaking gutter they've ignored for two months."*

Task. What exactly do you want done? *"Draft a letter asking for a repair date within 14 days."*

Format. What shape should the answer take? *"Keep it under 250 words, in three short paragraphs."*

Tone. How should it sound? *"Firm but courteous. I still have to live near these people."*

Context and task are the essentials; format and tone are the trim and polish. Four plain sentences, no magic words.

— THE MAGIC SENTENCE

| *"Before you answer, ask me five questions that would help you do this well."*

Use it for anything big, personal or fuzzy. The crew finds the gaps; you just answer questions about your own life. It asks, you answer, you stay in command.

— THE RESET RULE

If **two fixes** haven't worked, stop. Open a **fresh chat** and re-brief, including what went wrong last time. A new chat is a clean cockpit; restarting costs nothing.

— THE FIRST-DRAFT RULE

The first answer is a **first draft**, not the verdict. Reply and steer: 'warmer', 'shorter', 'make the middle paragraph about the garden'. The conversation is the tool.

✈️ CLEARED TO TRY

Pick one task you do every week. Build the brief with the four flight controls, or let the AI interview you. Do it together, then **compare the time** it usually takes with the time it took. If the prompt worked, save it: that's your library started.